Measure G

West Sonoma County Union High School District

Measure Question

2/3 (Two-Thirds) Needed to Pass

To continue supporting academic excellence for West Sonoma County Union students without increasing current tax rates; protect music, art, dance, shop, culinary and other career technical programs; retain teachers and staff; and keep class sizes low, shall West Sonoma County Union High School District's measure be adopted, renewing its existing parcel tax for eight years at the same rate of $79 per parcel, raising approximately $1,950,000 annually with exemptions including seniors and all funds staying local?

What Your Vote Means

YES	NO
A "yes" vote on Measure G will authorize the District to continue the education parcel tax.	A "no" vote on Measure G will not authorize the District to continue the tax.

For and Against Measure G

FOR	AGAINST
Sean McDonagh Chief of Police, Sebastopol Police Dept. Dorothy Rodella VP & Branch Manager Exchange Bank Loretta Castleberry President of Analy Alumni Assn. Herman G. Hernandez Trustee Area 5, Sonoma County Office of Education Diane Hughes Business Manager, West County Transportation	No argument was submitted against Measure G

Local Ballot Measure: G

Arguments and rebuttals are the opinions of the authors. They are printed exactly as submitted, including errors.

County Counsel's Impartial Analysis of Measure G

California law authorizes school districts to levy a special tax provided two-thirds of voters voting on the measure approve the tax. The West Sonoma County Union High School District Board of Trustees has placed on the ballot the question of whether the District should continue an education parcel tax for the specific purposes stated in the full text of Measure G.

Measure G proposes to continue a special tax of $79 annually per parcel for each parcel of land within the District's boundaries. The tax would begin on July 1, 2028, and would remain in effect for eight (8) years. The tax would be collected by the Sonoma County Tax Collector at the same time as and in the same manner as regular *ad valorem* property taxes and would be subject to the same penalties and interest that apply to *ad valorem* property taxes if not paid when due.

The proposed tax would apply to each parcel of taxable land in the District, subject to the exemptions below. Measure G defines "parcel" as any unit of land in the District that receives a separate tax bill from the Sonoma County Tax Collector. The tax would not apply to parcels that are exempt from property taxes. Additionally, upon application to the District, an exemption shall be available to parcels owned by: (i) one or more persons who are aged 65 years or older and own and occupy the parcel as a principal residence; or (ii) persons who receive Supplemental Security Income for a disability, regardless of age, and own and occupy the parcel as a principal residence. Further, contiguous parcels held under the same name and ownership will only be charged for one parcel provided the main parcel is the owner's primary residence.

If approved by voters, the proceeds of the tax would be deposited in a special fund and could only be used for the purposes set forth in the full text of Measure G. The stated purposes of the special parcel tax are to attract and retain highly qualified teachers and employees; provide high-quality programs in reading, writing, language arts, math, science, engineering and technology, music, and arts; update technology; maintain class size; and reduce impacts of State budget cuts.

If adopted, Measure G includes "Accountability Safeguards" that require the Board of Trustees to maintain tax proceeds in a separate account and annually conduct independent financial and performance audits. Measure G further requires the District's Chief Fiscal Officer to provide an annual report to the Board of Trustees detailing the amount of revenue collected and expended under the special tax and the status of any project funded by said tax revenue.

If approved, Measure G would raise approximately $1,950,000 annually.

A "yes" vote on Measure G will authorize the District to continue the education parcel tax.

A "no" vote on Measure G will not authorize the District to continue the tax.

JOSHUA A. MYERS
County Counsel

By: /s/ Adam Brand
Assistant County Counsel

Argument in Favor of Measure G

Our local high schools are the most important asset in our community and should be our number one priority. From higher achieving students, to training for future jobs, quality schools make a difference. However, because the state continues to reduce funding for public education, we need to do more to protect and maintain the quality of education. The West Sonoma County Union High School District relies on a local parcel tax for part of its funding. Funds raised by this local tax, first enacted in 1993 have been used to support instructional opportunities including counseling and library services, fine and performing arts, and technology.

Our students need your Yes vote on Measure G! If successful, Measure G will continue to provide a stable source of local funds to offset the uncertainty of state funding. With the kind of support provided by the funds from Measure G, our students can become well rounded, contributing members of the community. Without it, their educational experience will be compromised.

If passed, Measure G will fund programs to improve education without increasing the current parcel tax rate by: expanding and supporting music, art, and dance programs; maintaining small class sizes; improving career technical education programs; and retain quality teachers and staff.

Measure G makes financial sense and protects taxpayers. By law, all parcel tax funds must be spent locally and cannot be taken by the State. Measure G provides for an exemption for any parcel owned and occupied by a person 65 years of age or older. Also, spending will be reviewed and annually audited by an independent citizens' oversight committee.

Measure G maintains academic programs, helps improve the education of local students, and maintains the quality of our community. That's something we can all support. Please join us and vote Yes on Measure G!

/s/ Sean McDonagh
Chief of Police, Sebastopol Police Dept.

/s/ Dorothy Rodella
VP & Branch Manager Exchange Bank

/s/ Loretta Castleberry
President of Analy Alumni Assn.

/s/ Herman G. Hernandez
Trustee Area 5, Sonoma County Office of Education

/s/ Diane Hughes
Business Manager, West County Transportation

No Argument Was Submitted Against Measure G

Full Text of Measure G

PARCEL TAX RENEWAL MEASURE

By approval of this proposition by at least two-thirds of the registered voters voting on the proposition, the District will be authorized to continue the levy an education parcel tax of $79 per parcel for eight years to maintain a high-quality education in District schools, subject to the accountability requirements specified below.

PURPOSES

To continue to provide a local revenue source that cannot be taken by the State, the West Sonoma County Union High School District (the "District") proposes to continue to levy and collect an education parcel tax of $79 per parcel annually for eight years as more fully described below for the following specific purposes:

- Attract and retain highly qualified teachers and school employees;
- Provide high-quality programs in reading, writing, and language arts;
- Provide high-quality programs in math, science, engineering, and technology;
- Provide high-quality programs in music and the arts;
- Provide advanced, high-quality academic programs;
- Provide programs in arts;
- Keep technology updated;
- Provide instructional equipment, materials and supplies to support the District's prog
- Maintain manageable class sizes;
- Keep school facilities safe, clean, and well-maintained; and
- Reduce the impact of possible State budget cuts by providing a stable local funding source that cannot be taken away by the State or other school districts.

The Board of Trustees of the District will not fund any program other than those listed above from the proceeds of the education parcel tax.

EDUCATION PARCEL TAX AND PROCEDURES

Amount of Education Parcel Tax. Subject to two-thirds approval of the voters, the education parcel tax of $79 per parcel (except exempt parcels, as described below) shall continue and become effective commencing with fiscal year 2028-29 for eight years, and be collected by the County Tax Collector at the same time as and along with, and shall be subject to the same penalties as general *ad valorem* taxes collected by said tax collector. This Measure shall not impact the continued levy of any existing special tax previously adopted by District voters.

Definition of Parcel. A parcel shall be defined as any unit of land in the District that receives a separate tax bill for *ad valorem* property taxes from the County Tax Collector.

Exemptions. The following exemptions shall apply to the levy of the qualified special tax.

- *Otherwise Exempt Property*. All property that would otherwise be exempt from property taxes shall also be exempt from the education parcel tax.

- *Senior Citizen Exemption*. An exemption shall be available to persons who are 65 years or older and own and occupy as a principal residence a parcel subject to the education parcel tax.

- *Supplemental Security Income Exemption.* An exemption shall be available to persons who receive Supplemental Security Income ("SSI") for a disability, regardless of age, and own and occupy as a principal residence a parcel subject to the education parcel tax.

Property owners seeking an exemption must apply to the District for such exemption under procedures established by the District or otherwise as required by law.

Exclusive Procedures. The procedures described herein with respect to the levy and collection of the education parcel tax and exemptions, and any additional procedures established by the Board of Trustees of the District, shall be the exclusive claims procedure for claimants seeking an exemption, refund, reduction, or re-computation of the qualified special tax. Whether any particular claim is to be resolved by the District or by the County shall be determined by the District, in coordination with the County as necessary. The District's Board of Trustees may adopt such additional or supplemental procedures as it deems necessary or convenient for the administration of the education parcel tax.

ACCOUNTABILITY MEASURES

Government Code Accountability. In accordance with the requirements of California Government Code sections 50075.1 and 50075.3, the following accountability measures, among others, shall apply to the qualified special taxes levied in accordance with this Measure:

- the specific purposes of the education parcel tax shall be those purposes identified above under the heading "PURPOSES,"

- the proceeds of the education parcel tax shall be applied only to those specific purposes identified above under the heading "PURPOSES,"

- a separate, special account shall be created into which the proceeds of the education parcel tax must be deposited; and

- the chief fiscal officer of the District shall file an annual written report with the Board of Trustees of the District showing (1) the amount of funds collected and expended from the proceeds of the education parcel tax and (2) the status of any projects, programs, or purposes identified above under the heading "PURPOSES."

PROTECTION OF FUNDING

Current law forbids any decrease in State or Federal funding to the District because of the District's adoption of an education parcel tax. However, if any such funds are reduced because of the adoption of this education parcel tax, then the amount of the education parcel tax will be reduced annually as necessary in order to restore such State or Federal funding.

SEVERABILITY

The Board of Trustees of the District hereby declares, and the voters by approving this measure concur, that every section, paragraph, sentence and clause of this measure has independent value, and the Board of Trustees and the voters would have adopted each provision hereof regardless of every other provision hereof. Upon approval of this measure by the voters, should any part be found by a court of competent jurisdiction to be invalid for any reason, all remaining parts hereof shall remain in full force and effect to the fullest extent allowed by law.